

Comprehensive Toolkit: Facilitating a Condensed Security Council Simulation (15 Delegates + 13 Observers) on the Amu Darya Water Conflict

I. Introduction (Revised)

Purpose: This revised resource package provides a comprehensive toolkit designed to facilitate a successful and educationally valuable 3-hour Model UN Security Council simulation focused on the complex issue of the Amu Darya water conflict. Recognizing the time constraints often faced by educators and students, these materials are specifically adapted for a condensed 3-week preparation timeline and an intensive single-session simulation format, now accommodating **28 students** through a structure of **15 core delegates** and **13 supplementary non-delegate observer roles** (Press Corps, NGO Observers, Expert Advisors).

Target Audience: The materials herein are intended for use by both the 15 student delegates, the 13 student observers, and the teacher or organizer responsible for planning and executing the event.

Key Features: This toolkit emphasizes practicality and efficiency within the 15+13 structure. It includes:

- A **Delegate Guide (Revised)** tailored to the fast-paced format, highlighting strategic use of the Clause Bank and acknowledging observer interactions.
- **Observer Role Guides (New):** Specific briefs and instructions for students assigned to Press Corps, NGO Observer, and Expert Advisor roles.
- A **Chairing Guide (Revised)** with specific instructions for managing the 15 delegates *and* integrating the 13 observers effectively within the 3-hour timeframe.
- **Simplified Rules of Procedure (Revised)** defining delegate procedures and outlining protocols for observer participation and interaction.
- **Assessment Rubrics (Revised & New):** An updated rubric for delegates and new, tailored rubrics for each observer role.
- An **Organizer's Roadmap (Revised)** incorporating tasks related to assigning and preparing observer roles.
- **Strategic Setup Tips (Revised)** considering space and flow for both delegates and observers.
- A **Debriefing Guide (Revised)** with questions for both delegates and observers.
- The **Core Content Materials:** Background Guide, Country Policy Template, and Clause Bank, essential for both delegates and observers.

Relevance: This adapted structure allows a larger group to engage with the critical real-world challenge of transboundary water management in the Amu Darya basin ¹ while preserving the core Security Council simulation experience for 15 participants and offering unique learning pathways for the 13 observers.⁵

II. Delegate Guide for the Condensed Simulation (Revised)

(Note: Minor additions to acknowledge observers)

Welcome, Delegates, to this intensive Security Council simulation! This guide will equip you to navigate the unique challenges and opportunities of our condensed format focused on the Amu Darya water conflict. You are one of the 15 core voting members of the Council.

Section 2.1: Navigating the Fast Track: 3 Weeks Prep, 3 Hours Simulation

Context: This simulation adopts a condensed format to balance the depth required for meaningful engagement with the practicalities of limited time. It demands focused preparation and efficient participation. The standard Model UN experience often involves weeks or months of preparation for multi-day conferences; this model requires a targeted approach.

Preparation Timeline (3 Weeks): Your preparation will be intensive over the next three weeks. Refer to the Organizer's Roadmap (Part VII) for detailed weekly tasks, but broadly expect to:

- **Week 1:** Understand MUN basics, research your assigned country's general profile and initial stance on regional water security using provided templates and resources.
- **Week 2:** Define specific policy points related to the Amu Darya, familiarize yourself thoroughly with the **Clause Bank** and its purpose, and learn the **Simplified Rules of Procedure**.⁸
- **Week 3:** Develop your negotiation strategy, practice using the Clause Bank, finalize opening statement points, and prepare for the simulation's rapid pace.⁸

The condensed timeline necessitates a shift in preparation strategy. Instead of aiming for exhaustive research on every possible nuance, focus on mastering your country's core policy positions and understanding how to effectively leverage the provided materials, particularly the Clause Bank, to articulate those positions and build solutions. Efficiency and targeted learning are paramount.

Simulation Format (3 Hours): The simulation itself will move quickly. Expect the following approximate flow:

1. **Opening:** Roll Call, Setting the Agenda, Brief Opening Statements (focus on core positions).
2. **Debate & Discussion:** Short, focused Moderated Caucuses to explore specific facets of the problem.
3. **Negotiation & Drafting:** Significant time allocated to Unmoderated Caucus for bloc formation, negotiation, and drafting the resolution **using the Clause Bank**.
4. **Resolution Review:** Brief presentation/Q&A on the draft resolution(s), potentially limited amendments.
5. **Voting:** Formal voting procedure on the draft resolution(s).

This structure compels delegates to prioritize action and consensus-building over extensive debate. The primary goal is to collaboratively produce a Security Council resolution addressing the Amu Darya conflict within the allotted time.

Section 2.2: Focused Objectives: What Success Looks Like

Goal: The principal objective of this simulation is for the Security Council delegates to collaboratively negotiate and draft a resolution addressing key aspects of the Amu Darya water conflict, primarily utilizing the provided Clause Bank, within the 3-hour session.

Learning Outcomes: By the end of this simulation, you should aim to:

- **Accurately Represent:** Clearly articulate and defend your assigned country's core interests, policies, and potential "red lines" regarding the Amu Darya situation, based on your research and the provided policy template.
- **Engage Effectively:** Participate actively and constructively in moderated debates through focused statements and active listening. Ask questions that clarify positions or advance discussion.
- **Collaborate Strategically:** Work effectively with other delegates during the unmoderated caucus to form blocs, negotiate compromises, and build consensus, specifically demonstrating skillful use of the Clause Bank to construct a draft resolution.⁹
- **Adhere Diplomatically:** Demonstrate understanding and correct application of the simplified rules of procedure and maintain diplomatic courtesy and professional conduct throughout the simulation.

Success in this fast-paced format is defined less by individual rhetorical brilliance and more by the collective achievement of producing a viable draft resolution through

efficient teamwork and the strategic application of the provided tools, like the Clause Bank.⁹ It's about collaborative output under pressure.

Section 2.3: The Clause Bank: Your Toolkit for Negotiation

What it is: The Clause Bank is a pre-compiled list of potential preambulatory and operative clauses relevant to the Amu Darya water conflict. These clauses represent a range of perspectives and possible solutions that might appear in a Security Council resolution on this topic.

Purpose: Its primary function is to serve as a *starting point* and *accelerator* for your negotiation and drafting process during the unmoderated caucus. It helps overcome the challenge of drafting complex text from scratch under severe time constraints. It is **not** a restrictive menu; clauses can and should be adapted.

How to Use It Effectively (During Unmoderated Caucus):

- **Identify & Select:** Quickly scan the Clause Bank to find preambulatory and operative clauses that align with your country's policy objectives and preferred solutions. Choose those you want to champion within your negotiating bloc.⁹
- **Propose & Pitch:** Clearly propose selected clauses to your bloc members, explaining why they are important for your country and how they contribute to a comprehensive solution.⁹
- **Combine & Synthesize:** Look for opportunities to merge complementary clauses suggested by different delegates. Combining ideas can create stronger, more detailed, and more widely acceptable points.⁹ For example, one clause might call for monitoring, while another details funding – combining them creates a more complete mechanism.
- **Amend & Adapt:** This is crucial. Do not treat the clauses as fixed. Modify the wording of existing clauses to better reflect a compromise, strengthen a point, add specificity (like targets or timelines¹³), or align more closely with your bloc's emerging consensus. Use negotiation to agree on changes.
- **Negotiate Trade-offs:** Use your support for clauses favored by others as leverage to gain support for your own priorities. "If you support my clause on technical assistance, my delegation can support your clause on data sharing" is a valid negotiation tactic.⁹
- **Structure the Draft:** As your bloc agrees on clauses, begin organizing them into the proper resolution format: Header (Committee, Topic, Sponsors, Signatories), Preambulatory Clauses (starting with italicized phrases, ending in commas), and Operative Clauses (numbered, starting with underlined verbs, ending in semicolons – except the last, which ends in a period).

The Clause Bank fundamentally shifts the dynamic of the unmoderated caucus. Instead of focusing primarily on generating ideas and wording from scratch, your task becomes the strategic selection, adaptation, combination, and integration of these pre-existing components. Think of it as having building blocks available; your job is to negotiate which blocks to use and how to assemble them into a coherent structure that addresses the problem and satisfies the key stakeholders. Effective use requires understanding the policy implications of each clause and how modifications can lead to compromise and consensus.¹⁰

Section 2.4: Streamlined Procedure & Observer Interaction (Revised)

To ensure we focus on substance within our limited time, we will use simplified Rules of Procedure. Master these basics:

- **Speaking:**
 - Raise your country placard to be recognized by the Chair.
 - Address the Chair (e.g., "Honorable Chair...") and refer to other countries in the third person (e.g., "The delegate of Tajikistan stated...").
 - Adhere strictly to speaking time limits announced by the Chair.
- **Key Motions:**
 - **Motion for a Moderated Caucus:** Proposes a structured debate on a specific sub-topic. Must include: total time, speaking time per delegate, and the specific topic (e.g., "Motion for a 10-minute moderated caucus, 30-second speaking time, on the topic of funding mechanisms for infrastructure repair."). Use this to focus discussion.
 - **Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus:** Proposes a period of informal negotiation and drafting. Must include: total time (e.g., "Motion for a 20-minute unmoderated caucus."). This is your primary time to use the Clause Bank and build your resolution.
- **Key Points (Use Sparingly):**
 - **Point of Personal Privilege:** Use if you cannot hear a speaker or experience discomfort hindering participation.
 - **Point of Order:** Use if you believe a rule of procedure has been broken.
 - **Point of Inquiry:** Use if you have a question about the rules or procedure for the Chair.
- **Draft Resolutions:**
 - **Submission:** Requirements for sponsors/signatories will be announced by the Chair (likely simplified from standard rules). Submit your drafted text (using Clause Bank components) to the Chair when ready.
 - **Debate:** Brief presentation by sponsors, followed by a short Q&A period.

- **Amendments:** Procedures for amendments will be limited to maintain pace (details provided by Chair – likely focusing on friendly amendments or perhaps one key unfriendly amendment debate).
- **Voting:**
 - Procedural matters (like caucus motions) require a simple majority.
 - Substantive matters (draft resolutions, key amendments) require a majority vote **including the concurring votes of all five Permanent Members (P5: China, France, Russia, UK, US)**. This is the **veto power**.¹⁵ A "no" vote from any P5 member prevents the resolution from passing, even if it has a majority.
 - Abstentions do not count towards the majority but do not block passage (unless by a P5 member on a substantive vote, which acts as a veto).

Interacting with Observers: In addition to the 15 delegates, there will be non-voting observers present:

- **Press Corps:** Representing news agencies. They may request brief interviews during unmoderated caucuses or ask questions during a designated press conference. Engage professionally, representing your country's stance concisely.
- **NGO Observers:** Representing organizations focused on issues like environment, human rights, or development. They may approach you during unmoderated caucuses to lobby for specific perspectives or clauses. The Chair *may* grant them brief speaking time during formal debate. Listen courteously, but prioritize your negotiation objectives.
- **Expert Advisors:** Possessing technical knowledge (e.g., hydrology, regional agreements). You may request specific factual information from them *through the Chair* via a written note. They provide neutral information, not opinions or policy advice.

These interactions add realism but must be managed efficiently. Prioritize your core tasks of debate, negotiation, and drafting.

Section 2.5: Expectations for Participation and Diplomatic Conduct Under Pressure

The intensity of this condensed simulation requires focused effort and unwavering diplomacy:

- **Be Present and Active:** Engage consistently. This doesn't mean speaking constantly, but actively listening during moderated caucuses, contributing thoughtfully when you have substantive points, and being a proactive negotiator during unmoderated caucuses are essential.¹⁶ Quality contributions are valued over sheer quantity.

- **Collaborate, Don't Dominate:** The goal is a collective outcome. Work with your bloc members, listen to their perspectives, be willing to compromise, and leverage the Clause Bank together. Teamwork is critical.⁹
- **Maintain Diplomatic Decorum:** Always show respect to fellow delegates and the Chair, even during disagreements. Use formal language, address others by country name ("The delegate of Uzbekistan," not "you"), and avoid personal attacks or inflammatory language. Remember you represent a sovereign state.¹¹
- **Stay Focused and Efficient:** Come prepared. Know your key policy points and relevant clauses. Be concise in your speeches and negotiations. Manage your time effectively. Every minute counts.

The time pressure can be challenging, but it also provides a realistic simulation of high-stakes diplomacy. Maintaining composure, upholding respect, and fostering a collaborative spirit while working quickly are key learning objectives and critical expectations for your participation.

III. Observer Role Guides (New)

(Note: These are templates. The organizer needs to fill in specifics for each assigned role based on the Amu Darya topic.)

Section 3.1: Press Corps Guidance (Template)

Your Role: You are a journalist representing ****. Your task is to report accurately and engagingly on the Security Council's deliberations regarding the Amu Darya water conflict during this 3-hour simulation.

Your News Agency's Style/Bias:

Your Tasks (3 Hours):

1. **Observe:** Pay close attention to speeches during formal debate, the dynamics of negotiation during caucuses, and the content of draft resolutions. Identify key arguments, emerging blocs, points of contention, and potential breakthroughs.
2. **Interact:**
 - *Interviews:* During unmoderated caucuses, politely request brief (1-2 min) interviews with key delegates (e.g., P5, riparian states, bloc leaders). Prepare 1-2 focused questions based on their speeches or observed negotiations. Respect their time.
 - *Press Conference:* Participate actively in the scheduled press conference

(approx. 10 mins). Ask 1-2 insightful questions reflecting your agency's perspective and seeking clarification on proposed solutions or political dynamics.

3. **Report:** Produce **one concise news article (approx. 150-250 words)** by the end of the simulation. Your article should:
 - Have a clear headline.
 - Summarize a key development (e.g., a major proposal, a point of deadlock, the outcome of a vote).
 - Include at least one quote (real or paraphrased based on observation/interview).
 - Reflect your news agency's style and perspective (subtly).
 - Be submitted to the Chair/Organizer as directed.

Key Focus Areas for Amu Darya Conflict: Report on debates surrounding the Rogun Dam, Qosh Tepa canal impacts, water scarcity drivers (climate change, infrastructure), proposed solutions (regional agreements, technical aid, funding), P5 involvement, and overall progress towards a resolution.

Rules: Follow all Chair instructions and the Simplified RoP. Maintain professional journalistic conduct.

Section 3.2: NGO Observer Guidance (Template)

Your Role: You are an observer representing ****. Your goal is to advocate for your organization's mandate and perspectives related to the Amu Darya water conflict within the Security Council simulation.

Your NGO's Mandate & Stance:

Your Tasks (3 Hours):

1. **Observe:** Monitor the debate closely, identifying arguments, proposals (especially Clause Bank selections), and delegate positions relevant to your NGO's mandate. Note opportunities to influence the discussion or resolution text.
2. **Advocate:**
 - *Lobbying (Unmoderated Caucus):* Discreetly approach relevant delegates or blocs. Briefly present your NGO's key concerns and suggest specific actions or clause amendments that align with your mandate. Provide concise factual points if possible. Be respectful of delegates' negotiation time.
 - *Statement (Formal Debate - If Permitted):* If the Chair grants speaking time,

deliver a prepared, concise (max 60 seconds) statement highlighting your NGO's primary concern and offering a key recommendation. Submit a request to speak to the Chair early.

3. **Report/Reflect:** Be prepared to briefly summarize your advocacy efforts and observations during the final debriefing session. (Optional: Organizer might request a short written summary of key points lobbied).

Key Focus Areas for Amu Darya Conflict: Advocate on issues like environmental impact assessments for dams, protection of downstream agricultural communities, human rights related to displacement or water access, promotion of water-saving technologies, sustainable development goals, climate adaptation funding, transparency in water management, etc., depending on your NGO's specific mandate.

Rules: Follow all Chair instructions and the Simplified RoP. You cannot vote or make motions. Maintain professional advocacy conduct.

Section 3.3: Expert Advisor Guidance (Template)

Your Role: You are an Expert Advisor providing neutral, factual information on ****. Your function is to support the Security Council's deliberations with accurate data and context when requested.

Your Knowledge Base:

Your Tasks (3 Hours):

1. **Observe:** Follow the debate to understand the context in which information might be requested.
2. **Respond to Requests (Via Chair Only):**
 - You only provide information when a Delegate submits a specific, factual question *to the Chair*, and the Chair relays it to you.
 - Formulate a concise, accurate, and neutral answer based *only* on the factual information provided in your brief (or commonly accepted, verifiable data if allowed by organizer).
 - Provide the answer back to the Chair promptly.
 - **Do NOT:** Offer opinions, suggest policy solutions, interpret political implications, or engage directly in debate. Your role is strictly informational and reactive.

Key Focus Areas for Amu Darya Conflict: Be prepared to provide facts on river flows, dam specifications/impacts, existing treaty provisions, climate projections,

UNRCCA activities, agricultural water needs, etc., depending on your specific expertise and the questions asked.

Rules: Follow all Chair instructions and the Simplified RoP. You cannot vote, make motions, speak unless responding to a request via the Chair, or engage in lobbying/advocacy. Maintain strict neutrality.

IV. Chairing Guide for Condensed 3-Hour Security Council Simulation (Revised)

(Note: Significant additions to integrate observer management)

1. Introduction: Navigating the Fast Lane with Observers (Revised)

This guide provides Chairs with essential strategies for managing a highly condensed, 3-hour Model UN Security Council simulation involving **15 delegates and 13 non-delegate observers** (Press, NGOs, Experts). This format requires rigorous time management, efficient procedural control, clear communication, guiding delegates through Clause Bank use, *and* strategically integrating observer participation without derailing the core simulation. The Chair must be an active facilitator for *both* groups.

2. Mastering the Clock: Precision Time Management (Revised)

- **Adhering to the Schedule:** The proposed schedule must be treated as a firm roadmap. Display the schedule prominently (e.g., projected or written on a board) and announce progress against it frequently ("Delegates, we are now 45 minutes into the session; we should be moving towards our first moderated caucus shortly"). Regular time checks maintain awareness and urgency.
- **Enforcing Limits:** Individual speaking times must be strictly enforced. Use procedural tools like a gavel tap or polite but firm interjections ("Delegate, your time has expired. Please conclude your remarks.") to cut off speakers who exceed their allotted time. This must be done consistently and fairly, but without hesitation, to preserve time.
- **Managing Caucuses:** When motions for moderated or unmoderated caucuses are proposed and passed, the Chair must clearly state the precise start and end times. Provide audible time warnings during caucuses (e.g., "Ten minutes remaining in this unmoderated caucus," "Two minutes remaining"). Be prepared to gavel the caucus closed immediately when time expires, even if discussions are ongoing. Transition promptly to the next procedural step.
- **Time Benchmarks:** Utilize internal checkpoints based on the schedule (e.g.,

aiming to open the floor for draft resolution introductions around the 120-minute mark). If the committee falls behind, Chairs must use procedural tools—like suggesting shorter caucus durations or limiting speakers on a motion—to regain time. Common time sinks, such as lengthy points of order or slow transitions between speakers or caucus types, must be anticipated and proactively managed through clear instructions and decisive rulings.

- **Balancing Strictness and Transparency:** While rigorous timekeeping is essential, it should not stifle participation or create undue frustration. Communicate the reasons for strict timekeeping – explaining that it is necessary to allow the committee to progress through all phases of debate and action within the limited time available. This transparency helps maintain delegate buy-in even when enforcing limits.
- **Allocate Observer Time:** Explicitly factor in brief, structured time slots for observer interactions (e.g., NGO statements, press conference) within the overall 180-minute schedule. These must be planned, not spontaneous additions.

3. Navigating the Debate Flow: Efficient Transitions with Observers (Revised)

- **Opening Debate & Speakers' List:** Begin with Roll Call and the Motion to Open Debate. The initial Speakers' List allows delegates to deliver brief opening statements outlining their country's core position. Keep this phase concise, adhering strictly to the schedule and individual speaking times.
- **Transitioning to Moderated Caucus:** Guide the committee swiftly towards substantive discussion via moderated caucuses. Encourage delegates to propose motions for moderated caucuses focused on specific sub-topics or questions that relate to the challenges presented in the background guide or the categories within the Clause Bank. This focused discussion primes delegates for the negotiation phase.
- **Managing Moderated Caucuses:** Keep speakers strictly to the established topic and time limits. Use the speakers' list efficiently. Limit the number and duration of moderated caucuses based on the overall schedule, ensuring they serve to clarify positions and identify areas of potential agreement or disagreement relevant to resolution drafting.
- **Transitioning to Unmoderated Caucus (Clause Bank Focus):** This is a critical transition point. Clearly signal the shift to the negotiation and drafting phase. Explicitly state the time allocated and reiterate the primary objective: for blocs to collaborate using the pre-provided Clause Bank to construct draft resolutions. Before entertaining the motion for the unmoderated caucus, provide a brief, clear explanation of how the Clause Bank works (see Section 4 below). This preemptive guidance is vital to prevent confusion and wasted time during the caucus itself.

- **Overseeing Unmoderated Caucus:** While delegates negotiate, the Chair(s) should circulate the room. The primary role here is to observe progress, maintain decorum, and answer *procedural* questions about using the Clause Bank, formatting, or sponsorship requirements. Avoid intervening in the substance of negotiations unless requested for procedural clarification or if decorum breaks down. Gently remind blocs of the remaining time.
- **Returning to Formal Debate:** Manage the transition back to formal debate smoothly and promptly when the unmoderated caucus time expires. Prepare to move into the phase of introducing and amending draft resolutions.
- **Integrating NGO Statements:** If allowing NGO statements (see RoP), schedule these strategically during formal debate, perhaps after the initial speakers' list or between moderated caucuses. Keep them strictly timed (e.g., 60 seconds each).
- **Managing Press Conference:** If holding a press conference, schedule it clearly (e.g., for 10 minutes at the start or middle of the main unmoderated caucus). The Chair facilitates this, ensuring questions are concise and relevant, and delegates provide brief answers.
- **Facilitating Expert Input:** Handle requests for expert information efficiently. Receive written questions from delegates, relay them clearly to the designated Expert Advisor, receive the factual answer, and relay it back to the requesting delegate or the committee as appropriate, time permitting. This should not halt debate significantly.

4. Facilitating the Clause Bank: Guiding Drafting (Revised)

- **Initial Explanation (Pre-Caucus):** Before the first unmoderated caucus, deliver a concise explanation covering:
 - Purpose: To streamline the drafting process and focus negotiation on substance within the time limit.
 - Structure: How the bank is organized (e.g., thematic categories, preambulatory vs. operative clauses).
 - Access: How delegates can view and select clauses (e.g., shared digital document, physical copies).
- **Selection and Combination:** Clarify that delegates should work in blocs to select clauses relevant to their agreed-upon solutions. Emphasize that clauses should be combined logically to form a coherent draft resolution. Remind them of the need for a minimum number of sponsors as defined in the RoP.
- **Amending Clauses:** Crucially, explain that the pre-written clauses are *starting points* and *can be amended*. Delegates can modify, add to, or delete parts of clauses. Guide them on how to clearly mark these changes within their draft documents so they can be formally proposed as amendments later if necessary,

or incorporated directly if agreed upon by sponsors. Explicitly encouraging amendment prevents the Bank from stifling creativity and allows for more nuanced solutions.

- **Chair's Role During Caucus:** Be readily available to answer *procedural* questions regarding: selecting/combining clauses, formatting requirements, sponsorship rules, and how to handle amendments within the bloc. Do not offer substantive advice on which clauses to choose or how to solve the issue. A subtle tracking of which clauses are being considered by different blocs (perhaps via a shared document or discreet observation) can help anticipate overlap and potentially guide blocs towards differentiation if needed, saving time during formal debate.
- **Observer Influence (Indirect):** Remind delegates that information or perspectives gained from NGOs or Experts (via Chair) can inform their choices and amendments when using the Clause Bank. Press coverage might also subtly influence bloc dynamics.

5. Handling Points and Motions: Swift and Decisive (Revised)

- **Know the Essentials:** Chairs must have absolute clarity on the *simplified* set of points (Personal Privilege, Parliamentary Inquiry, Order) and motions (Open Debate, Moderated Caucus, Unmoderated Caucus, Introduce Draft Resolution, Amend Draft Resolution, Vote on Draft Resolutions) permitted by the simulation's specific RoP. Be prepared to rule out of order any points or motions not on this list.
- **Prioritize Relevance and Brevity:** Rule points out of order quickly if they are dilatory, substantive, or not aligned with the defined purpose of the permitted points. Keep responses to inquiries brief and focused on the procedure.
- **Efficient Processing:** Recognize delegates for points or motions promptly. Ensure motions meet requirements (e.g., specifying time/topic for caucuses). State the point or motion clearly to the committee. Conduct votes (usually by placard count) swiftly and announce the result immediately. Move to the next item of business without delay.
- **Limit Redundancy:** Tactfully discourage motions that are repetitive or do not substantially advance the committee's progress according to the schedule (e.g., multiple short moderated caucuses on an already discussed sub-topic). Guide delegates towards motions that move the committee into the next necessary phase (e.g., towards unmoderated caucus for drafting, or towards voting).
- **'Waves of Motions':** At natural transition points (e.g., after a speech concludes, at the end of a caucus), proactively ask "Are there any points or motions on the floor?". Entertain all motions, then order them for voting from most to least disruptive (e.g., Motion to Vote on Draft Resolutions before Motion for Moderated

Caucus). This prevents procedural interruptions and manages flow efficiently. A quick reminder of the *permitted* points and motions at the very start of the simulation can prevent confusion and save time later.

- **Observer Procedural Points:** Clarify that observers generally cannot raise points or make motions, except perhaps a Point of Personal Privilege if they genuinely cannot hear/see proceedings. Press may ask clarifying questions during a press conference.

6. Encouraging Broad Participation: Inclusivity Under Pressure (Revised)

- **Track Speaking Time:** Maintain a simple, informal tally of which delegates have spoken and how often. This helps identify who needs encouragement.
- **Direct Encouragement:** Do not hesitate to gently invite contributions from less vocal delegates, especially those whose country's position is highly relevant to the current point of discussion. Examples: "The Chair sees the delegate from [Country X] has not had an opportunity to speak recently. Would the delegate care to take the floor?" or placing them higher on moderated caucus speakers' lists.
- **Varying Formats:** Recognize that some delegates thrive in formal speeches, while others excel in the negotiation environment of unmoderated caucuses. Ensure adequate time (within schedule limits) for both formats. During unmoderated caucuses, observe bloc dynamics and subtly encourage the inclusion of delegates who may be on the periphery.
- **Targeted Questions:** During moderated caucuses, Chairs can pose questions related to the specific topic that might naturally draw responses from particular countries known to have strong policies or interests in that area.
- **Acknowledge Contributions:** Verbally acknowledge contributions, especially from quieter delegates, to reinforce participation.
- **Realistic Expectations:** Given the 3-hour limit for 15 delegates, ensuring every delegate speaks for an equal amount of time is impossible. The goal is to ensure *opportunity* for all and prevent domination by a few, rather than achieving perfect parity of speaking time. Focus on creating openings and maintaining an inclusive atmosphere.
- **Engaging Observers:** While circulating during unmoderated caucus, briefly check in with observer groups (Press, NGOs) to ensure they understand their tasks and are finding opportunities for interaction (interviews, lobbying). Ensure Experts are ready to respond if called upon via the Chair.

7. Managing Observer Interactions (New Section)

- **Structured Integration:** Observer participation must be structured, not chaotic.

Use the schedule and RoP protocols strictly.

- *NGO Lobbying*: Allow NGOs to approach delegates *discreetly* during unmoderated caucuses, but remind delegates their priority is negotiation/drafting. Intervene if lobbying becomes disruptive.
- *Press Interviews*: Encourage Press to request brief (1-2 minute) interviews during unmoderated caucuses, respecting delegates' time. The Chair can help facilitate initial connections if needed.
- *Press Conference*: Facilitate this efficiently. Introduce the delegate speakers (perhaps bloc representatives), manage Q&A time strictly, ensure questions are relevant, and cut off lengthy answers.
- *NGO Statements*: If permitted by RoP, call on NGOs formally during debate, enforce time limits strictly, and thank them for their input before moving on.
- *Expert Input*: Act as the sole conduit for expert information requests to maintain formality and control flow.
- **Maintain Delegate Focus**: Continuously remind delegates that their primary task is to represent their country and work towards a resolution. Observer interactions provide context but should not dominate delegate time or attention.
- **Chair as Gatekeeper**: The Chair actively manages observer access and participation according to the rules and schedule to prevent the simulation from becoming fragmented or losing focus on the core Security Council work.

8. Maintaining Diplomatic Composure: Order in the Council (Revised)

- **Upholding Decorum**: Be vigilant in maintaining a respectful and professional environment. Remind delegates of the expected standards of diplomatic courtesy. Use standard calls for "Decorum" or, if necessary, a brief pause in proceedings to address any breaches, such as interruptions, loud side conversations, or disrespectful remarks. The fast pace can increase frustration; proactive management of tone is crucial.
- **Ensuring Impartiality**: The Chair's neutrality is paramount. Treat all delegates, blocs, and draft resolutions fairly. Base all procedural rulings strictly on the simplified RoP document, not on personal opinions or the perceived merit of substantive arguments. Avoid any appearance of bias.
- **Managing Challenges**: Address Points of Order calmly and confidently. Explain the ruling clearly by referencing the specific rule in the simplified RoP. Handle substantive disagreements by reminding delegates of diplomatic language and guiding the focus back to procedural mechanisms for resolving differences (e.g., amendments, voting).
- **Conflict Resolution (Procedural)**: If procedural disputes arise (e.g., interpretation of a rule, use of the Clause Bank), provide a clear, concise, and final

ruling to keep the simulation moving. Prolonged procedural debates cannot be afforded.

- **Modeling Composure:** The Chair's own demeanor is critical. By remaining calm, organized, fair, and in control, especially when making difficult rulings or managing time pressure, the Chair models the expected diplomatic behavior for delegates and maintains the credibility needed to guide the committee effectively.
 - **Observer Decorum:** Ensure observers also adhere to standards of professional conduct, especially during interactions like press conferences or lobbying.
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V. Simplified Rules of Procedure (RoP) for Condensed 3-Hour Security Council Simulation (Revised)

(Note: Additions defining observer status and interaction protocols)

1. Introduction: Rules for Rapid Deliberation (Revised)

Welcome to this condensed 3-hour Security Council simulation involving **15 Delegates and 13 non-delegate Observers**. These Rules of Procedure (RoP) are specifically designed for this fast-paced format and the use of the provided Clause Bank. **Only the points, motions, and procedures outlined in this document are permitted.** Standard Model UN rules or procedures not explicitly mentioned here do not apply. Familiarity with these specific rules is essential for all participants.

2. Participants

- **Delegates (15):** Representing the Member States of the Security Council. Possess full speaking and voting rights.
- **Observers (13):** Representing Press Corps, Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs), or Expert Advisors. Observers **do not have voting rights**. Their participation is governed by the specific protocols below.
- **Chair/Dais:** Facilitates the simulation according to these rules.

3. Essential Points of Procedure (Revised)

Points are used by delegates to raise procedural matters or address personal needs. Only the following three points are in order:

- **Point of Personal Privilege:** Used when a delegate experiences personal discomfort that hinders their ability to participate (e.g., inability to hear the speaker, room temperature). This point **cannot** interrupt a speaker. Raise it by raising your placard when no one else has the floor.

- **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry:** Used to ask the Chair a question about these Rules of Procedure. This point **cannot** interrupt a speaker. Raise it by raising your placard when no one else has the floor.
- **Point of Order:** Used when a delegate believes there has been an error in the way the rules are being applied by the Chair or another delegate. This point **may only interrupt a speaker** if the procedural error relates directly to the speaker's current action (e.g., speaking over time, discussing the wrong topic in a moderated caucus). Otherwise, raise it when the speaker has concluded.

Limitation: No other points (such as Point of Information) are in order during this simulation.

Applicability: Points may generally only be raised by Delegates. Observers may only raise a Point of Personal Privilege if experiencing genuine difficulty participating (e.g., cannot hear).

Table 1: Permitted Points Summary

Point Name	Purpose	Can Interrupt Speaker?	Raised By
Point of Personal Privilege	Address personal discomfort (audibility, etc.)	No	Delegate / Observer
Point of Parliamentary Inquiry	Ask Chair about rules of procedure	No	Delegate
Point of Order	Correct a perceived error in procedure	Only if urgent	Delegate

4. Essential Motions (Revised)

Motions are proposed by delegates to direct the flow of debate or committee action. Only the following motions are in order. All motions require a **Simple Majority** (more than half of members present and voting) to pass, unless otherwise specified.

- **Motion to Open Debate:** Proposes to begin formal debate on the agenda topic at the start of the session.
- **Motion for Moderated Caucus:** Proposes a timed, formal caucus on a specific sub-topic. The delegate proposing the motion **must** specify: 1) Total time for the caucus, 2) Topic of the caucus, and 3) Individual speaking time per delegate.
- **Motion for Unmoderated Caucus:** Proposes a timed, informal caucus for negotiation and drafting using the Clause Bank. The delegate proposing the motion **must** specify the total time.

- **Motion to Introduce Draft Resolution:** Proposes that the committee formally consider a specific draft resolution that has been approved by the Chair as meeting format and sponsorship requirements. Requires the draft resolution number (e.g., "Motion to introduce Draft Resolution 1.1").
- **Motion to Amend Draft Resolution:** Proposes a specific change (addition, deletion, or modification) to a draft resolution that is currently on the floor. The proposed amendment must be clearly stated.
- **Motion to Vote on Draft Resolutions:** Proposes to close debate on the current topic and move immediately into voting procedure on all introduced draft resolutions.

Limitation: No other motions (such as Motion to Adjourn, Motion to Table Debate, Motion to Close Speakers' List) are in order during this simulation.

Applicability: Motions may only be made by Delegates.

Table 2: Permitted Motions Summary

Motion Name	Purpose	Requirements	Voting Threshold	Made By
Motion to Open Debate	Start formal debate	None	Simple Majority	Delegate
Motion for Moderated Caucus	Structured debate on sub-topic	Specify Total Time, Topic, Speaking Time	Simple Majority	Delegate
Motion for Unmoderated Caucus	Informal negotiation/drafting (using Clause Bank)	Specify Total Time	Simple Majority	Delegate
Motion to Introduce Draft Res.	Bring approved draft resolution to floor	Chair approval; Specify DR number	Simple Majority	Delegate
Motion to Amend Draft Res.	Propose change to a DR on the floor	State amendment clearly	Simple Majority	Delegate
Motion to Vote on Draft Res.	Close debate and proceed to	None	Simple Majority	Delegate

	voting			
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5. Utilizing the Clause Bank for Draft Resolutions

Draft Resolutions in this simulation are constructed primarily using the provided Clause Bank during Unmoderated Caucuses.

- **Access:** The Chair will provide access to the Clause Bank document (e.g., electronically or via printouts).
- **Selection and Combination:** Delegates work in blocs to select relevant preambulatory and operative clauses from the Bank. These clauses should be combined logically to address the problem effectively. **Delegates may only use and amend clauses from the provided Bank; writing entirely new clauses is not permitted in this format to ensure focus and speed.**
- **Formatting:** Draft resolutions must adhere to standard UN format:
 - **Header:** Must include Committee Name (Security Council), Topic, Sponsors, and the Draft Resolution Number (assigned by the Chair upon submission).
 - **Preambulatory Clauses:** Start with appropriate italicized phrases (e.g., *Recalling, Affirming*) and end with a **comma (,)**.
 - **Operative Clauses:** Start with appropriate underlined or italicized verbs (e.g., *<u>Requests</u>, Calls upon*), are numbered sequentially, and end with a **semicolon (;)**, except for the final operative clause, which ends with a **period (.)**.
- **Sponsorship:** A minimum of **three (3) Sponsors** is required to submit a draft resolution. Sponsors are delegates who have contributed to writing the draft and agree with its entire content. Signatories are not used in this simulation.
- **Submission:** Completed draft resolutions must be submitted to the Chair (electronically or physically, as directed). The Chair will quickly review for correct formatting and the required number of sponsors before accepting it and assigning a number (e.g., Draft Resolution 1.1, 1.2). Only then can a Motion to Introduce Draft Resolution be made.

6. Amending Draft Resolutions

Once a draft resolution has been introduced, delegates may propose amendments to modify its content.

- **Purpose:** To add, delete, or change specific words or phrases in an operative or preambulatory clause of a draft resolution already on the floor.
- **Types:**

- **Friendly Amendment:** A proposed change that **all** original sponsors of the draft resolution agree to. If all sponsors confirm their agreement to the Chair, the amendment is automatically incorporated into the draft resolution without needing a motion or vote.
- **Unfriendly Amendment:** A proposed change that is **not** agreed upon by one or more of the original sponsors.
- **Procedure for Unfriendly Amendments:**
 1. A delegate must make a **Motion to Amend Draft Resolution**, clearly stating the proposed change.
 2. The motion requires a **Simple Majority** vote to be considered.
 3. If the motion passes, the Chair will allow brief debate on the amendment itself (typically limited to one speaker for and one speaker against the amendment).
 4. After brief debate, the committee votes on the unfriendly amendment. A **Simple Majority** is required for the amendment to pass.
 5. If the amendment passes, the Chair announces that the draft resolution is now considered amended accordingly. If it fails, the draft resolution remains in its original form.

7. Voting Procedures

Voting on draft resolutions is the final stage of committee action.

- **Moving into Voting:** Occurs immediately after a Motion to Vote on Draft Resolutions passes. The Chair will declare that the committee has moved into voting procedure. Debate is closed, and no further motions are in order except Points of Order related specifically to the conduct of the vote.
- **Voting Order:** The Chair will announce the order in which draft resolutions will be voted upon (e.g., Draft Resolution 1.1, then Draft Resolution 1.2, etc.). Any passed amendments are considered part of the resolution being voted on.
- **Conduct of Vote:** For each draft resolution, the Chair will call for votes:
 - "All those in favour, please raise your placards." (Count is recorded)
 - "All those against, please raise your placards." (Count is recorded)
 - "All those abstaining, please raise your placards." (Count is recorded)
 - Each of the 15 members of the Security Council has one vote.
- **Passing Requirement (Security Council Specific):** For a draft resolution to be adopted by the Security Council, it must receive:
 - At least **nine (9)** affirmative ("in favour") votes, **AND**
 - **No** "against" votes from any of the five Permanent Members (P5): China, France, the Russian Federation, the United Kingdom, and the United States.
- **P5 Veto:** A single "against" vote from any P5 member constitutes a **veto**, causing

the draft resolution to fail automatically, regardless of the number of affirmative votes. An abstention by a P5 member is **not** a veto.¹⁹ This unique rule significantly influences negotiation, requiring blocs to seek P5 support or at least avoid their opposition.

- **Announcement:** Immediately following the vote count for each draft resolution, the Chair will announce the results (number in favour, against, abstaining) and state clearly whether the resolution "Passes" or "Fails". The Chair must manage this final stage formally and maintain decorum, especially if a veto occurs.

8. Observer Participation Protocols (New Section)

- **General Status:** Observers (Press, NGOs, Experts) are non-voting participants. They must maintain decorum and follow Chair instructions.
- **Press Corps:**
 - *Observation:* May observe all open formal and informal sessions.
 - *Interviews:* May request brief (max 2 minutes) interviews with Delegates during Unmoderated Caucuses, subject to delegate availability and Chair's guidance on decorum.
 - *Press Conference:* A single, timed (e.g., 10-minute) press conference may be scheduled by the Chair, likely during the main Unmoderated Caucus. Press Corps members may ask questions of designated Delegate speakers.
 - *Output:* Expected to produce written articles/reports as per their specific guidance.
- **NGO Observers:**
 - *Observation:* May observe all open formal and informal sessions.
 - *Lobbying:* May discreetly approach Delegates/blocs during Unmoderated Caucuses to share perspectives or advocate for positions relevant to their mandate. Must avoid disrupting negotiations.
 - *Statements:* The Chair *may*, time permitting and at their discretion, grant one representative from each accredited NGO a single, brief (max 60 seconds) speaking opportunity during formal debate to provide relevant information or perspectives. Requests for speaking time must be submitted to the Chair in writing.
 - *Output:* Expected to engage in advocacy and potentially produce brief summaries/reports as per their guidance.
- **Expert Advisors:**
 - *Observation:* May observe all sessions.
 - *Providing Information:* Experts provide factual, neutral information *only* when requested by a Delegate *through the Chair*. They do not offer opinions, policy advice, or participate in debate.

- *Procedure:* Delegates submit specific, factual questions in writing to the Chair. The Chair relays the question to the relevant Expert. The Expert provides a concise, factual answer back to the Chair, who then relays it to the requesting Delegate or the committee, time permitting.

VI. Evaluating Performance: Assessment Rubrics (Revised & New)

Section 6.1: Assessment Focus (Revised)

Rationale: This assessment rubric is specifically designed for the condensed 3-hour simulation format involving 15 delegates and 13 observers. It prioritizes observable behaviors that demonstrate effective preparation, meaningful participation, strategic collaboration (particularly using the Clause Bank for delegates), and adherence to core diplomatic principles and simplified procedures. Given the time constraints, the focus shifts from exhaustive displays of knowledge to efficient and impactful engagement.¹⁷ Separate rubrics are provided for Delegates and each Observer role, reflecting their distinct tasks and objectives.

Section 6.2: Assessment Rubric Table (Delegates - Revised)

Criteria	Excellent (4 pts)	Good (3 pts)	Developing (2 pts)	Needs Improvement (1 pt)
Preparation & Policy Knowledge (Based on Country Policy Template)	Consistently demonstrates deep understanding of country's core interests, priorities, and likely positions on Amu Darya issues. Effectively uses policy knowledge to inform debate and negotiation strategy. Clearly identifies potential	Demonstrates good understanding of country's main interests and positions. Uses policy knowledge appropriately in debate/negotiations on most of the time. Identifies some potential allies/adversaries.	Demonstrates basic understanding of country's position but struggles to apply it consistently or strategically. Vague understanding of allies/adversaries.	Demonstrates minimal understanding of country's position. Little evidence of preparation influencing participation or strategy.

	allies/adversaries.			
Participation in Debate (Quality over Quantity)	Actively listens and makes relevant, concise, and impactful contributions during moderated caucuses. Speeches/comments clearly advance the debate, propose viable ideas, or build consensus. Asks insightful questions.	Participates consistently in moderated caucuses with relevant points. Speeches/comments generally contribute positively to the debate. Asks appropriate questions.	Participates occasionally but contributions may lack substance, clarity, or relevance. May struggle with active listening or asking pertinent questions.	Minimal participation in formal debate, or contributions are off-topic, repetitive, or hinder progress. Little evidence of active listening.
Negotiation & Clause Bank Use (Collaboration & Strategy) ⁹	Actively leads or significantly contributes to bloc formation and negotiation during unmoderated caucus. Highly collaborative and works effectively to build consensus. Demonstrates sophisticated use of the Clause Bank: strategically selects, combines, <i>and</i> amends clauses to achieve policy goals and facilitate compromise. Plays a key role	Actively participates in unmoderated caucus and collaborates well with bloc members. Uses the Clause Bank effectively: selects relevant clauses and participates in combining/amending them. Contributes meaningfully to drafting the resolution.	Participates in unmoderated caucus but may be passive or struggle with collaboration. Shows basic use of the Clause Bank: selects some clauses but may not engage deeply in combining or amending. Limited contribution to drafting.	Minimal participation in unmoderated caucus or actively hinders collaboration. Little or ineffective use of the Clause Bank. Does not contribute to drafting efforts.

	in drafting the resolution.			
Adherence to Diplomacy & Procedure	Consistently maintains diplomatic decorum, respect, and professional conduct. Uses simplified rules of procedure correctly and efficiently to facilitate debate. Accurately represents country policy throughout the simulation.	Generally maintains diplomatic decorum and uses procedures correctly. Represents country policy accurately most of the time.	Occasional lapses in decorum or procedural errors. May sometimes misrepresent country policy or struggle to use rules effectively.	Frequent breaches of decorum (disrespectful, disruptive). Significant procedural errors hindering debate. Fails to accurately represent country policy.

Section 6.3: Assessment Rubric Table (Press Corps - New)

Criteria	Excellent (4 pts)	Good (3 pts)	Developing (2 pts)	Needs Improvement (1 pt)
Journalistic Inquiry & Interaction	Actively seeks information through insightful, relevant questions during press conference & interviews. Professionally engages delegates, respecting time constraints. Builds rapport effectively.	Asks relevant questions during press conference & interviews. Engages delegates appropriately most of the time.	Asks some questions but may lack focus or relevance. Interaction may be hesitant or occasionally unprofessional.	Minimal or ineffective questioning/interaction. Fails to gather useful information or disrupts proceedings.

Reporting Quality (News Article)	Article is clear, concise, accurate, well-structured (headline, lede). Effectively summarizes key development(s). Includes relevant quote(s). Subtly reflects assigned agency style/bias. Submitted on time.	Article is mostly clear and accurate. Summarizes a development adequately. Includes quote(s). Shows some attempt at agency style. Submitted on time.	Article may lack clarity, accuracy, or structure. Summary is vague or incomplete. Quotes may be missing or irrelevant. Little evidence of agency style. May be late.	Article is unclear, inaccurate, poorly written, or irrelevant. Fails to summarize key events. No quotes. No attempt at agency style. Not submitted or very late.
Understanding of Topic & Agency	Demonstrates strong understanding of the Amu Darya conflict dynamics and the assigned news agency's perspective through questions and writing.	Shows good understanding of the topic and agency perspective.	Shows basic understanding of topic/agency but struggles to apply it effectively.	Little understanding of the topic or assigned agency's perspective.
Professionalism & Collaboration	Consistently maintains professional journalistic conduct. Collaborates effectively with other Press Corps members (if applicable) and interacts respectfully with Chairs/Delegates. Adheres to	Generally maintains professional conduct and collaborates appropriately. Adheres to rules most of the time.	Occasional lapses in professionalism or collaboration. Minor procedural errors.	Unprofessional conduct, poor collaboration, or significant disregard for rules/instructions.

	rules.			
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Section 6.4: Assessment Rubric Table (NGO Observer - New)

Criteria	Excellent (4 pts)	Good (3 pts)	Developing (2 pts)	Needs Improvement (1 pt)
Advocacy & Mandate Representation	Clearly, concisely, and persuasively advocates for NGO's mandate/position during lobbying interactions and/or formal statement (if applicable). Effectively links NGO concerns to specific debate points or clauses.	Effectively advocates for NGO mandate/position most of the time. Makes relevant connections to the debate.	Attempts advocacy but message may be unclear, irrelevant, or poorly timed. Struggles to connect mandate to specific debate points.	Minimal or ineffective advocacy. Fails to represent NGO mandate clearly or appropriately.
Strategic Engagement	Strategically targets relevant delegates/blocs for lobbying. Provides concise, useful information/suggestions. Makes effective use of limited interaction opportunities (caucus time, statement).	Engages appropriately with delegates/blocs. Provides relevant information. Uses interaction opportunities reasonably well.	Engagement may be unfocused or poorly timed. Information provided may lack relevance or impact. Misses opportunities for interaction.	Passive observation or disruptive/ineffective engagement. Fails to utilize interaction opportunities.
Understanding of Topic & NGO	Demonstrates strong understanding	Shows good understanding of the topic and	Shows basic understanding of topic/NGO	Little understanding of the topic or

	of the Amu Darya conflict and the assigned NGO's specific role, concerns, and potential contributions.	NGO role/concerns.	but struggles to apply it effectively in advocacy.	assigned NGO's mandate/perspective.
Professionalism & Diplomacy	Consistently maintains professional advocacy conduct (respectful, non-disruptive). Interacts courteously with Chairs/Delegates. Adheres strictly to rules regarding observer participation.	Generally maintains professional conduct and interacts courteously. Adheres to rules most of the time.	Occasional lapses in professionalism or procedural adherence (e.g., overly persistent lobbying, attempting to speak out of turn).	Unprofessional conduct (disruptive, disrespectful). Significant disregard for rules governing observer participation.

Section 6.5: Assessment Rubric Table (Expert Advisor - New)

Criteria	Excellent (4 pts)	Good (3 pts)	Developing (2 pts)	Needs Improvement (1 pt)
Accuracy & Relevance of Information	Consistently provides accurate, relevant, and factual information strictly within the assigned area of expertise in response to requests relayed by the Chair.	Provides generally accurate and relevant information within expertise area.	Information provided may sometimes be inaccurate, irrelevant, or stray outside the defined expertise.	Provides inaccurate, irrelevant, or opinion-based information. Fails to adhere to expertise area.

Clarity & Conciseness	Responses (relayed via Chair) are exceptionally clear, concise, and easy to understand. Directly addresses the specific question asked.	Responses are mostly clear and concise. Adequately addresses the question.	Responses may be unclear, overly lengthy, or fail to directly address the question.	Responses are confusing, verbose, or non-responsive.
Neutrality & Role Adherence	Strictly maintains neutrality, providing only factual information without expressing opinions, policy preferences, or engaging in debate. Adheres perfectly to the reactive, informational role.	Maintains neutrality most of the time. Generally adheres to the informational role.	Occasionally offers opinions or information beyond factual response. May attempt to engage beyond the defined role.	Fails to maintain neutrality. Offers unsolicited opinions or policy advice. Does not adhere to the expert role.
Responsiveness & Professionalism	Responds promptly (via Chair) when requested. Maintains professional demeanor throughout. Follows all Chair instructions and RoP regarding expert participation.	Responds in a timely manner most of the time. Maintains professional demeanor. Follows rules generally.	Responses may be delayed. Minor lapses in professionalism or procedural adherence.	Fails to respond promptly or professionally. Disregards rules or Chair instructions.

Section 6.6: Applying the Rubric: Notes for Evaluators (Revised)

- **Observation Focus:** During the 3-hour session, evaluators (Chair/Teacher) should prioritize observing delegate actions, especially during the dynamic unmoderated caucus where negotiation and Clause Bank use are most evident.
- **Holistic Assessment:** Evaluate the delegate's overall contribution to the committee's progress. Consider their impact on their bloc's ability to negotiate and draft, rather than simply counting speeches or submitted clauses. Did their presence help or hinder the process?
- **Clause Bank Interaction:** Pay specific attention to *how* delegates engage with the Clause Bank. Are they merely selecting pre-written text, or are they demonstrating strategic thinking by discussing implications, proposing amendments, and combining clauses thoughtfully to build consensus or advance specific policy aims? This interaction is a key indicator of adapting to the simulation's specific tools.
- **Differentiated Observation:** Evaluators must track participation across different role types (Delegate, Press, NGO, Expert), applying the relevant rubric. This requires careful attention to both formal debate and informal caucus interactions.
- **Assess Observer Impact:** For observers, evaluate not just their actions but their *impact* within the simulation's constraints. Did the Press article capture a key moment? Did the NGO lobbying subtly shift a bloc's focus? Did the Expert's information clarify a critical point?
- **Constructive Feedback:** Use the specific language and criteria in the rubric to provide targeted, actionable feedback during the post-simulation debriefing session. This helps students understand their strengths and areas for improvement within the context of this unique simulation format.
- **Feedback Specificity:** Use the distinct rubrics to provide role-specific feedback during the debriefing.

VII. Organizer's Roadmap: 3-Week Preparation Checklist (Revised)

Purpose: This checklist provides a structured timeline with key tasks and milestones for the teacher or organizer facilitating the condensed 3-week preparation period leading up to the 3-hour Security Council simulation (15 delegates + 13 observers).

Format: Weekly Checklist Table

Week	Task	Status	Notes / Resources
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Week 1: Laying the Groundwork	[] Introduce MUN, SC basics, 15+13 simulation format , Amu Darya context.	☐	
	[] Distribute Delegate Guide (Revised - Part II) . Explain expectations for delegates <i>and</i> briefly mention observer roles.	☐	
	[] Assign Roles: Assign 15 Delegate countries (Tips Part VIII.1). Assign 13 Observer roles (New Tips Part VIII.2 - Press agencies, NGOs, Expert areas). Announce assignments.	☐	Role List, Student Preferences/Experience
	[] Provide Country Policy Research Template (Part X.2) to Delegates.	☐	Template Document
	[] Provide Observer Role Guides (Templates - Part III) to Observers. Assign specific agencies/NGOs/expertise areas.	☐	Observer Guides, List of Agencies/NGOs
	[] Assign initial research task (Delegates: Country/Policy; Observers: Agency/NGO/Expertise Area & Amu Darya links). Direct to key	☐	Resource List

	resources.		
	[] Briefly introduce core MUN concepts (diplomacy, consensus) & observer roles (journalism, advocacy, expertise).	☐	
Week 2: Deepening Policy & Skills	[] Review initial research (Delegates & Observers). Facilitate discussion on potential delegate alliances & observer interaction points.	☐	
	[] Introduce Clause Bank (Part X.3) to Delegates. Explain purpose & use. Conduct practice activity.	☐	Clause Bank Document
	[] Teach Simplified RoP (Revised - Part V): Cover delegate procedures <i>and</i> observer protocols. Run procedural drill including observer interaction examples (e.g., requesting expert info).	☐	Revised RoP Cheat Sheet, Drill Scenarios
	[] Discuss negotiation strategies (Delegates) & interaction strategies (Observers - interviews, lobbying).	☐	Strategy Tips Handout
	[] Assign task:	☐	Templates/Guides

	Delegates refine policy/clauses/speech. Observers refine agency stance/NGO talking points/expert facts & prepare sample questions/statements.		
Week 3: Final Preparations & Logistics	[] Conduct mini-simulation/practice session: Include delegates using Clause Bank <i>and</i> observers practicing interactions (interviews, lobbying requests, expert Q&A via Chair). Provide feedback.	☐	Practice Scenario
	[] Review final delegate opening points & observer interaction plans.	☐	
	[] Confirm simulation logistics (Date, time, location/platform). Test tech, including breakout rooms & shared docs if virtual.	☐	Logistics Plan
	[] Prepare materials: Delegate placards, Observer ID badges/placards , Clause Bank copies, Rubrics (Delegate & Observer - Part VI), pens/paper, gavel, timer. Ensure shared doc access.	☐	Materials Checklist

	[] Distribute Assessment Rubrics (Revised & New - Part VI) to all students. Explain criteria for their specific role.	☐	
	[] Final Q&A. Reinforce expectations for delegates <i>and</i> observers. Review interaction protocols.	☐	
	[] Prepare Debriefing Guide (Revised - Part IX) for post-simulation reflection (delegate & observer questions).	☐	Debriefing Questions

VIII. Strategic Setup for Organizers (Revised)

Section 8.1: Assigning Roles: Country Assignment Tips (Revised)

Country assignment in a Security Council simulation significantly shapes the debate and negotiation dynamics, especially within a condensed timeframe. Careful consideration of the P5/E10 structure and student experience is crucial.¹⁸

- **P5 Realism vs. Simulation Flow:** The five Permanent Members (P5: China, France, Russia, UK, US) possess veto power over substantive resolutions.¹⁵ While assigning these roles enhances realism, the veto can quickly derail a short simulation if used obstructively.¹⁵
 - **Considerations:** Assign P5 roles to students capable of understanding the strategic weight and responsibility of the veto. A mix of experienced and capable mid-level students might work. Be mindful of specific P5 interests in the Amu Darya context:
 - *China:* Likely focused on regional stability for its Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), energy security, and managing influence relative to Russia and the US.²⁶ May prioritize infrastructure cooperation but be wary of instability risks.²⁹
 - *Russia:* Historical influence in Central Asia, complex energy/water

relationships stemming from the Soviet era, potential interest in balancing other powers.³³ May have views on large dam projects like Rogun.³⁴

- *United States*: Interests often framed around regional stability, counter-terrorism, promoting cooperation on water management, supporting development, and balancing China/Russia influence.³⁹ May support data sharing and demand management initiatives.⁴¹
- *France/UK*: May align with broader international norms, focus on humanitarian aspects, environmental concerns, or support specific development/security frameworks.
- **Leveraging the E10**: The ten Elected Members (E10) often play a vital role in drafting resolutions, brokering compromises, and building consensus, acting as a bridge between P5 members or representing regional perspectives.²⁴ For 2025, these are Algeria, Denmark, Greece, Guyana, Pakistan, Panama, Republic of Korea, Sierra Leone, Slovenia, and Somalia.⁴⁵
 - **Strategy**: In this condensed format, assigning experienced, proactive, or diplomatically skilled students to key E10 positions can be highly effective. They can drive the negotiation process forward and help prevent P5 deadlock, increasing the likelihood of reaching a substantive outcome within the 3 hours. This can provide a more engaging educational experience than a simulation stalled by vetoes.
- **Matching Experience**:
 - *Novice Delegates*: Consider assigning countries with relatively straightforward policy stances or those less central to the immediate upstream/downstream conflict. This allows them to focus on learning procedures, basic negotiation, and representing a position accurately. Remember, even smaller countries can exert influence through good ideas and diplomacy.²³
 - *Experienced Delegates*: Suitable for P5 roles (with the caveat above), key E10 roles (especially potential bloc leaders or mediators), or countries with complex stakes in the Amu Darya conflict (e.g., the primary riparian states).
- **Amu Darya Context is Key**: Ensure the simulation includes the most relevant actors:
 - *Riparian States*: Afghanistan, Tajikistan (upstream, Rogun Dam focus ⁴⁷), Uzbekistan (downstream, major agricultural user, historical opponent to Rogun ⁵¹), Turkmenistan (downstream, significant water user ⁵²). (Note: Afghanistan is not on the SC, but its actions (Qosh Tepa canal) are relevant context).
 - *Other Regional Actors*: Potentially Kazakhstan (downstream concerns ⁵²), Kyrgyzstan (upstream water/energy dynamics ⁵²). (Note: Neither are on the 2025 SC).

- *External Powers*: P5 members, particularly China, Russia, US due to regional interests.
- *Observers (Optional)*: Consider roles for UN agencies like UNRCCA (promotes regional dialogue on water ⁵⁶) or the World Bank (involved in assessments like Rogun ³⁴) to provide information or context, perhaps through the Chair or assigned as Expert Advisor roles.

Assigning countries requires balancing realism with pedagogical goals. For this short simulation, prioritizing a dynamic negotiation process that allows students to engage with the Clause Bank and reach *some* outcome might mean strategically empowering the E10 to facilitate consensus, even if it slightly reduces the potential for absolute P5 deadlock seen in the real UN.¹⁵ Explicitly incorporating the key riparian states and external powers with documented interests ensures the conflict's core dynamics are represented.⁵²

Section 8.2: Assigning Observer Roles (New Tips)

Assigning the 13 observer roles requires matching student interests and skills to the tasks involved. Consider:

- **Press Corps (3-5 students)**: Suitable for students interested in writing, journalism, current events, or critical analysis. Assign distinct, real-world news agencies with potentially different perspectives (e.g., Western agency like Reuters/AP, regional agency like Times of Central Asia, state-affiliated agency like Xinhua/TASS, broadcaster like BBC/Al Jazeera) to encourage diverse reporting angles.⁶
- **NGO Observers (4-6 students)**: Ideal for students passionate about specific issues (environment, human rights, development, water access) or interested in advocacy and lobbying. Assign specific, relevant NGOs (e.g., WWF, Human Rights Watch, WaterAid, International Crisis Group, local Central Asian environmental groups) with clear mandates related to the Amu Darya conflict.⁷ Ensure a mix of perspectives (e.g., environmental conservation vs. human development needs).
- **Expert Advisors (2-3 students)**: Best for students who enjoy detailed research, prefer factual analysis over debate, and can maintain neutrality. Assign distinct areas of expertise crucial to the Amu Darya debate (e.g., Hydrology/Dam Engineering, International Water Law/UNRCCA, Climate Science/Impacts in CA). Provide them with concise factual briefs. Emphasize their reactive, neutral role.
- **Balancing Experience**: Observer roles can be excellent for both novice and experienced students. Press/NGO roles allow for active engagement through writing and interaction. Expert roles suit quieter students strong in research. Pair roles with student strengths where possible.

- **Clarity is Key:** Ensure each observer clearly understands their specific organization/expertise, their expected tasks within the 3-hour simulation, and the rules governing their interaction with delegates. Provide them with their tailored guidance sheet (Part III).

Section 8.3: Setting the Stage: Room Setup Suggestions (Revised)

The environment must accommodate 15 delegates, 13 observers, and the Dais, facilitating both formal debate and structured interactions.⁶⁹

- **Physical Setup (Classroom/Meeting Room):**
 - **Delegate Area:** Maintain the U-shape/horseshoe for the 15 delegates facing the Dais. Ensure clear country placards.
 - **Observer Areas:** Designate specific, slightly separated areas for observers:
 - *Press Table:* A table at the side or back for Press Corps members to work on laptops/notes.
 - *NGO Seating:* Chairs along the sides or back for NGO observers, allowing visibility of the debate but distinct from the delegate tables.
 - *Expert Seating:* Position Experts near the Dais for easy communication with the Chair (who acts as the intermediary).
 - **Caucus Flow:** Ensure ample space for delegates to form blocs during unmoderated caucus. Observers (Press/NGOs) need clear pathways to approach blocs *without* overcrowding or disrupting delegate negotiations. The Chair needs space to circulate among delegates *and* check in with observers.
 - **Technology/Visibility:** Projector/screen visible to all (delegates and observers). Consider a whiteboard/flipchart for observer interaction schedules (e.g., press conference time).
- **Virtual Setup (e.g., Zoom, Microsoft Teams):**
 - **Main Session Room:** For all formal debate. Use screen sharing for lists/motions/drafts. Chat for formal requests (expert info, NGO speaking time) to Chair.
 - **Breakout Rooms (Unmoderated Caucus):** Primarily for delegate blocs. Consider:
 - *Optional Observer Rooms:* Create separate, optional breakout rooms for Press or NGOs to coordinate briefly among themselves, *or* allow them to join delegate bloc rooms as *observers* (if tech allows and delegates agree). Clear protocols are needed.
 - *Chair Circulation:* Chair needs co-host ability to move between delegate breakout rooms and potentially check in on any observer rooms/channels.

- **Collaborative Tools:** Shared documents for delegate drafting. Consider a separate shared doc or channel for Press Corps coordination or for the Chair to post expert responses.
- **Communication:** Main chat for formal requests. Breakout room chat for bloc work. Direct messaging might be used by Press/NGOs to request brief delegate interactions, but encourage moving to a quick breakout if more than a simple question is needed.

The key is spatial or digital organization that allows observers to see and interact according to the rules without hindering the core delegate work within the tight schedule. Clear visual separation (physical) or channel management (virtual) is important.

IX. Learning from Experience: Teacher/Organizer Debriefing Guide (Revised)

Section 9.1: The Value of Reflection (Revised)

The debriefing session immediately following the simulation is a crucial pedagogical component. It provides a structured opportunity for students to process their experiences, articulate challenges and successes, connect the simulation's dynamics and outcomes to real-world international relations, and consolidate their learning about the Amu Darya conflict, Security Council functions, and MUN skills.¹² This includes reflections from both delegates *and* observers on their distinct experiences and interactions.

Section 9.2: Guiding the Debrief: Key Questions (Revised)

Organize the discussion around the following themes, ensuring questions are posed to both delegates and relevant observer groups:

Theme 1: The Condensed Format & Pace (For All):

- How did the 3-week preparation timeline and 3-hour simulation limit impact your approach to research, strategy, and negotiation/observation?
- What aspects of the simulation felt most rushed? What parts worked surprisingly well under the time pressure?
- How did the fast pace influence the dynamics of negotiation and the quality of the decisions made? Did it force compromise or lead to superficial agreements?

Theme 2: Effectiveness of the Clause Bank (For Delegates):

- How helpful or unhelpful did you find the Clause Bank during the unmoderated caucus? Explain your reasoning.⁹
- Did the Clause Bank accelerate drafting and negotiation effectively? Did it feel like a useful scaffold or a limitation on creativity?
- Describe specific ways you (or your bloc) used the Clause Bank – selecting, combining, amending clauses. What strategies were most effective?¹¹
- If we were to use a Clause Bank again, how could it be improved (e.g., content, organization, types of clauses)?

Theme 3: Negotiation & Diplomacy Under Pressure (For Delegates):

- What were the biggest challenges you faced trying to negotiate and build consensus in such a short amount of time?⁹
- Can you share an example of a successful negotiation or compromise during the unmoderated caucus? What factors contributed to its success (e.g., finding common ground, effective communication, strategic use of clauses)?¹²
- Can you describe a point where negotiation stalled or failed? What were the main obstacles?
- How effectively did you balance advocating for your country's specific interests with the need to find common ground and achieve a collective outcome?¹¹

Theme 4: Observer Interaction Experience (New Theme):

- **For Delegates:** How did interactions with Press/NGOs/Experts affect your experience? Were they helpful, distracting, or realistic? How easy/difficult was it to engage with them effectively within the time limits?
- **For Press Corps:** What were the biggest challenges in gathering information and reporting accurately under time pressure? How effective were the interview/press conference opportunities? Did you feel you could accurately portray your news agency's perspective?
- **For NGO Observers:** How effective were your lobbying efforts? Did you feel you had adequate opportunities to present your NGO's concerns? What were the challenges in influencing delegates within the simulation structure?
- **For Expert Advisors:** Did the questions you received (via Chair) align with your expertise? Was the process for providing information clear and efficient? Did you feel your role contributed effectively to the simulation?
- **For All:** How could the interaction between delegates and observers be improved in future simulations of this type?

Theme 5: Security Council Dynamics & The Amu Darya Conflict (For All):

- How did the presence of P5 members and their veto power affect the

negotiations and the potential outcome? ¹⁵

- (If applicable) Was the veto (or the threat of veto) used? How did this impact the simulation? Did it feel like a realistic reflection of SC power dynamics, or primarily an obstacle in this format? ¹⁵
- What key insights did you gain about the complexities of the Amu Darya water conflict (e.g., upstream vs. downstream perspectives, role of infrastructure, climate impacts, external influences)? ¹
- In what ways did this simulation reflect the real-world challenges and limitations faced by the UN Security Council in addressing complex international issues? ⁷⁴
- **Add for Observers:** How did observing the SC dynamics (e.g., P5 influence, bloc negotiations) inform your understanding of international decision-making from your perspective (media, civil society, expert)?

Theme 6: Personal Learning & Skill Development (For All):

- Which skills (e.g., public speaking, negotiation, critical thinking, teamwork, research synthesis) do you feel you practiced or developed most during this simulation? ¹⁶
- Reflecting on your preparation and participation, what is one thing you would do differently if you participated in this simulation again? ¹²

Section 9.3: Facilitation Tips (Revised)

- **Create a Safe Space:** Foster an environment where students feel comfortable sharing honest reflections, including challenges and frustrations, without fear of judgment.
- **Ensure Broad Participation:** Actively solicit input from quieter delegates. Techniques like a brief "think-pair-share" before opening the floor or a structured round-robin can be effective.
- **Bridge Simulation and Reality:** Explicitly draw connections between events or dynamics observed in the simulation (e.g., bloc formation, negotiation tactics, impact of veto, difficulty reaching consensus on specific clauses) and real-world diplomatic practices and Security Council proceedings.
- **Focus on Process, Not Just Outcome:** Guide the discussion towards analyzing the *how* and *why* of the simulation – the negotiation process, the use of the Clause Bank, the decision-making journey – rather than solely focusing on whether a resolution passed or "who won."
- **Highlight the Clause Bank Experience:** Since the Clause Bank is a key adaptation, ensure sufficient time is spent discussing its perceived effectiveness, usability, and impact on the negotiation dynamics. This feedback is vital for refining the simulation design.

- **Address the Veto:** Facilitate a nuanced discussion about the veto's role. Did its presence (or use) accurately simulate SC power dynamics, or did it disproportionately hinder progress in the short format? Exploring strategies delegates used (or could have used) to navigate the veto is valuable.¹⁵
- **Include All Voices:** Make a conscious effort to solicit feedback specifically from students in each observer role category, ensuring their unique experiences are heard alongside the delegates'.
- **Discuss Observer Integration:** Dedicate specific time to discussing how well the observer roles were integrated. Was the balance right? Were the interaction protocols effective? This feedback is crucial for refining the 15+13 model.
- **Summarize Key Learnings:** Conclude the debriefing by synthesizing the main takeaways related to the topic, MUN skills, SC dynamics, and the effectiveness of the condensed format and its tools. Reinforce the educational value derived from the experience.

X. Core Content Materials

Section 10.1: Background Guide: Escalating Water Conflict in the Amu Darya Basin

(Note: This guide is designed to be concise, fitting approximately one page)

A. Essential Historical Context

The Amu Darya River, originating in the glaciers of Tajikistan and Afghanistan, flows through Turkmenistan and Uzbekistan before historically emptying into the Aral Sea. During the Soviet era, water resources in Central Asia were managed centrally from Moscow under an integrated water-energy system.³⁷ Upstream republics (Tajikistan, Kyrgyzstan) stored water in reservoirs during winter and released it during summer months to support vast irrigation schemes, primarily for water-intensive cotton cultivation, in downstream republics (Uzbekistan, Turkmenistan, Kazakhstan).³⁴ In return, downstream republics supplied upstream neighbours with fossil fuels (gas, coal) during winter.³⁷ This system, while enabling massive agricultural expansion, led to inefficient water use and contributed significantly to the ecological catastrophe of the Aral Sea's shrinkage.³⁴ With the dissolution of the USSR in 1991, this centrally managed barter system collapsed.³⁴ Newly independent states prioritized national interests: upstream nations focused on maximizing winter hydropower generation for energy security, while downstream nations continued to demand large volumes of water for summer irrigation.³⁷ Early attempts at regional cooperation through bodies like the Interstate Commission for Water Coordination (ICWC), established by the 1992 Almaty Agreement, have struggled with enforcement and adapting Soviet-era quotas to new

realities.³⁴

B. Summary of Current Situation & Recent Developments

Central Asia faces mounting water stress driven by climate change (accelerating glacial melt initially increasing flow but threatening long-term supply, altered precipitation), rapid population growth, and severely outdated and inefficient Soviet-era irrigation infrastructure, which can waste up to 50-60% of diverted water.⁵ Recent droughts have exacerbated shortages, impacting agriculture and livelihoods.⁴⁰

Central to current tensions is Tajikistan's ongoing construction of the massive Rogun Dam on the Vakhsh River, a major tributary of the Amu Darya.³⁴ Aiming to be the world's tallest dam, Rogun is framed by Tajikistan as essential for achieving energy independence, overcoming chronic power shortages (especially in winter), and driving economic development through electricity exports.⁶⁵ Historically, Uzbekistan fiercely opposed Rogun, fearing the lengthy reservoir filling period (potentially years) and subsequent operational regime would drastically reduce vital summer water flow for its cotton and rice agriculture, increase flood risks from winter releases, and threaten its food security.³⁴ While tensions eased somewhat under Uzbekistan's President Mirziyoyev, with potential agreements for energy purchases emerging⁶⁵, fundamental concerns about water allocation remain. The project faces significant financing challenges and has raised human rights concerns regarding the resettlement of thousands of people.⁶⁵

Adding further complexity is Afghanistan's construction of the large-scale Qosh Tepa Canal, designed to divert substantial water from the Amu Darya for irrigation, raising alarms in downstream Uzbekistan and Turkmenistan about further reductions in water availability.⁴⁰ Separately, unresolved border demarcation issues, partly linked to local water access, have periodically led to violent clashes between Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan, highlighting the region's fragility.²

C. Key State and Non-State Actors Involved

- **Riparian States:**

- *Upstream:* **Tajikistan** (main proponent of Rogun Dam, seeks energy security/export revenue), **Kyrgyzstan** (significant hydropower potential on Syr Darya, faces similar energy/water trade-offs, border disputes with Tajikistan).
- *Downstream:* **Uzbekistan** (largest population, heavily reliant on Amu Darya for agriculture, historically opposed Rogun but stance softening), **Turkmenistan** (significant agriculture reliant on Amu Darya diversion via Karakum Canal, also impacted by Qosh Tepa), **Kazakhstan** (primarily reliant on Syr Darya but

affected by overall Aral Sea basin health and regional stability).

- **Other Key State: Afghanistan** (constructing Qosh Tepa Canal, impacting Amu Darya flows, stability affects region).
- **External Powers: Russia** (traditional regional power broker, past involvement in Rogun financing attempts, seeks influence)³⁴, **China** (major investor via Belt and Road Initiative, prioritizes regional stability for economic corridors, energy interests)³⁰, **USA** (promotes regional stability, counter-terrorism, water security initiatives/aid, competes for influence).³⁹
- **International Organizations: UNRCCA** (mandated with preventive diplomacy, facilitates regional dialogue on water)⁶², **World Bank** (conducted Rogun assessments, potential major financier)³⁴, **IFAS/ICWC** (regional bodies for Aral Sea Basin management, limited authority/effectiveness).³⁴

D. Overview of Relevant Past UN Actions / International Agreements

The 1992 Almaty Agreement established the ICWC and set initial post-Soviet water allocation quotas based largely on historical usage, but lacked effective enforcement mechanisms and failed to anticipate current challenges like climate change and new large infrastructure.³⁴ Numerous subsequent regional agreements have had limited success in creating a sustainable, cooperative framework.³⁴ There is no comprehensive, legally binding modern treaty governing the entire Amu Darya basin that adequately addresses current environmental pressures and national priorities. The UN Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia (UNRCCA), established in 2007, plays a key role in facilitating dialogue among the Central Asian states on transboundary issues, including water management, and reports regularly to the Security Council.⁶² The World Bank has funded and overseen crucial technical, environmental, and social impact assessments for the Rogun Dam project, influencing international perceptions and potential financing.³⁴

E. Core Points of Contention & Potential Stakes

The central conflict pits upstream desires for hydropower generation (requiring water release primarily in winter) against downstream needs for agricultural irrigation (requiring water release primarily in summer).³⁷ This is intensified by:

- **Rogun Dam:** Tajikistan's sovereign right to develop resources vs. downstream states' water security concerns; dam safety in a seismic zone; financing viability; and social impacts of displacement.⁶⁵
- **Climate Change:** Decreasing overall water availability and increasing variability heightens competition for scarce resources.⁵
- **Inefficiency:** Massive water losses due to dilapidated Soviet-era irrigation

infrastructure exacerbate scarcity, yet modernization requires huge investment and regional coordination.⁵³

- **Lack of Trust & Data:** Insufficient transparency and reliable shared data on water flows and usage hamper cooperative solutions.⁴¹
- **Geopolitics:** External powers' involvement (Russia, China, US) can influence regional dynamics, potentially hindering or facilitating cooperation based on their own strategic interests.³⁹ The Central Asian water crisis serves as an arena where these powers compete and cooperate, using infrastructure and aid as tools of influence, complicating purely regional solutions and potentially constraining the neutral diplomatic space needed by bodies like UNRCCA.⁵⁹

Stakes: Failure to manage these tensions risks **regional instability** and potential **inter-state conflict** ⁷³, jeopardizing **food security** (especially downstream), **energy security** (especially upstream), **economic development**, triggering **human displacement** ⁷³, and worsening **environmental degradation**.

Section 10.2: Country Policy Research Template: Escalating Water Conflict in the Amu Darya Basin

(Instructions for Delegates: Use this template to guide your research on your assigned country's position regarding the Escalating Water Conflict in the Amu Darya Basin. Focus specifically on information relevant to this crisis. Your goal is to accurately represent your country's likely stance and priorities in the Security Council simulation. Aim for concise, policy-relevant answers. Consult suggested sources and general MUN research guides.)

Assigned Country: _____ **Committee:** Security Council

Topic: Escalating Water Conflict in the Amu Darya Basin

A. Country's General Stance on Transboundary Water Management & Water Security

1. What are your country's official principles or doctrines regarding the management of shared international water resources (e.g., adherence to the UN Watercourses Convention principles of equitable and reasonable utilization, obligation not to cause significant harm, prior notification, absolute territorial sovereignty)?
 - *Research Notes:*
2. In international forums, does your country typically prioritize water allocation for specific uses (e.g., agriculture, hydropower, environmental flows, human right to

water)? How does this manifest in its foreign policy or development aid?

- *Research Notes:*

3. What is your country's general position on the relationship between climate change and international security? Does it view water scarcity as a potential driver of conflict? ⁸¹

- *Research Notes:*

B. Specific Relationships & Interests Concerning Central Asia & Key Actors

1. Describe your country's diplomatic, economic (trade, investment), and security relationships with the key riparian states: Tajikistan, Uzbekistan, Turkmenistan, Kyrgyzstan, Kazakhstan, and Afghanistan. Are there key alliances or rivalries?

- *Research Notes:*

2. Does your country have specific strategic interests in Central Asia (e.g., access to energy resources, trade routes like the BRI, counter-terrorism cooperation, regional stability, balancing influence of other major powers)? How might the Amu Darya water conflict affect these interests? (Consider P5 perspectives: Russia – historical influence, EAEU ²⁸; China – BRI stability, energy imports ²⁹; US – stability, counter-terrorism, democracy promotion, aid ⁴³)

- *Research Notes:*

3. What is your country's official view on the role and effectiveness of the UN Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia (UNRCCA), particularly concerning water issues? ⁵⁹

- *Research Notes:*

C. Relevant National Economic or Security Interests at Play

1. Does the water situation in the Amu Darya Basin have any direct or indirect economic consequences for your country (e.g., impact on national companies invested in the region, disruption to trade routes, effect on global commodity prices like cotton)?

- *Research Notes:*

2. What are the potential security implications for your country arising from instability in Central Asia linked to water scarcity (e.g., refugee flows, cross-border impacts of conflict, growth of extremist groups exploiting grievances, disruption to energy supplies)? ⁷³

- *Research Notes:*

3. Does your country view Central Asian water security as directly linked to its own national security, energy security, or geopolitical positioning? Why or why not?

- *Research Notes:*

D. Past Official Statements, Voting Records, or Actions

1. Search for official statements from your country's government (Head of State, Foreign Ministry, UN Mission) regarding the Rogun Dam, the Qosh Tepa canal, Aral Sea issues, or general water management cooperation/disputes in Central Asia.
 - *Research Notes (Include dates/sources if possible):*
2. Examine your country's voting record in the UN General Assembly and Security Council on resolutions related to Central Asia, UNRCCA, transboundary water management principles, or climate security. (Use UN Digital Library).
 - *Research Notes (Include resolution numbers if possible):*
3. Has your country provided development aid, technical assistance, or investment specifically related to water management, irrigation, hydropower, or climate adaptation in Central Asia? ³⁹
 - *Research Notes:*

E. Key National Priorities / Non-Negotiable Points ("Red Lines") (Identify 2-3)

1. Based on your research, what are the 2-3 most critical objectives your country would seek to achieve or protect in a Security Council resolution addressing the Amu Darya water conflict? (Examples: Upholding specific water law principles, ensuring stability for energy/trade routes, protecting national investments, preventing regional conflict spillover, promoting a specific model of development, countering a rival's influence).
 - Priority 1:
 - Priority 2:
 - Priority 3 (Optional):
2. What specific outcomes or actions proposed in a resolution would your country likely find unacceptable and potentially veto (if P5) or strongly oppose?
 - *Research Notes:*

F. Suggested Reliable Sources

- **Official Government Websites:** Your assigned country's Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Permanent Mission to the UN.
- **UN Resources:**
 - UN Digital Library (for resolutions, voting records, official documents):
<https://digitallibrary.un.org/>
 - Security Council Website (meeting records, resolutions, press statements):
<https://www.un.org/securitycouncil/> ⁷⁸
 - Security Council Report (independent analysis & updates):

<https://www.securitycouncilreport.org/> ⁷⁹

○ UNRCCA Website: <https://unrcca.unmissions.org/> ⁶²

- **Think Tanks & Research Institutes:** (Search for reports on Central Asia, water security, specific country policies)
 - International Crisis Group (ICG) ⁷⁶
 - Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS) ⁷³
 - Carnegie Endowment for International Peace ⁵⁰
 - Atlantic Council ³⁹
 - World Resources Institute (WRI) ²
- **News Agencies:** Reuters, Associated Press (AP), BBC World, Al Jazeera English, regional news sources (e.g., Eurasianet, RFE/RL).
- **General Background:** CIA World Factbook (basic country data):
<https://www.cia.gov/the-world-factbook/>

Section 10.3: Clause Bank: Escalating Water Conflict in the Amu Darya Basin

(Purpose: This clause bank provides sample preambulatory and operative clauses related to the Amu Darya Basin water conflict. Delegates can use these as starting points – adopting, amending, combining, or reacting against them – during negotiation and drafting of resolutions in the simulation. Clauses reflect a range of perspectives and potential actions. Correct MUN formatting is used.)**

A. Sample Preambulatory Clauses

1. *Affirming* the sovereign right of all States to develop and utilize their natural resources pursuant to their own environmental and developmental policies, while recognizing their responsibility to ensure that activities within their jurisdiction or control do not cause significant harm to other States,
2. *Recalling* the principles enshrined in the Convention on the Law of the Non-Navigational Uses of International Watercourses (1997), particularly those concerning equitable and reasonable utilization and the obligation not to cause significant harm,
3. *Deeply concerned* by the growing water scarcity and environmental degradation in the Amu Darya Basin, exacerbated by the adverse effects of climate change, including accelerated glacier melt, altered precipitation patterns, and increased frequency of droughts, which pose a significant threat to livelihoods and regional stability ⁵,
4. *Recognizing* the critical dependence of downstream riparian States, namely the Republic of Uzbekistan, Turkmenistan, and potentially the Republic of Kazakhstan, on the waters of the Amu Darya for irrigated agriculture, food security, and socio-economic stability ⁵,

5. *Acknowledging* the legitimate aspirations of upstream riparian States, particularly the Republic of Tajikistan, to harness hydropower potential for energy security, economic diversification, and sustainable development, including through projects such as the Rogun Hydropower Plant ⁶⁵,
6. *Noting with appreciation* the continued efforts of the United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy for Central Asia (UNRCCA) in facilitating dialogue and promoting a cooperative atmosphere among the Central Asian States on transboundary water management issues ⁶²,
7. *Bearing in mind* the potential transboundary impacts of large-scale water infrastructure developments, including the Rogun Dam in Tajikistan and the Qosh Tepa Canal in Afghanistan, on water availability, flow regimes, and environmental conditions throughout the Amu Darya Basin ³⁴,
8. *Emphasizing* the crucial need for enhanced transparency, timely notification, comprehensive data sharing, and joint technical assessments concerning water resource management and infrastructure projects among all riparian States ⁴¹,
9. *Alarmed by* the potential for unresolved water disputes to escalate existing tensions, fuel instability, and potentially lead to inter-state friction or conflict, thereby constituting a threat to international peace and security in the region ⁷³,
10. *Underscoring* the importance of integrated water resource management (IWRM) approaches that consider the interconnectedness of water, energy, food security, and ecosystems within the entire basin,
11. *Reaffirming* the Security Council's previous discussions recognizing climate change as a threat multiplier that can exacerbate existing drivers of conflict and instability.⁸¹

B. Sample Operative Clauses

1. *Urges* all riparian States of the Amu Darya Basin – Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, and Uzbekistan – to intensify negotiations, with the facilitation of UNRCCA if requested, towards the conclusion of a comprehensive, modern, and legally binding basin-wide agreement based on the principles of equitable and reasonable utilization, the obligation not to cause significant harm, and cooperation;
2. *Calls upon* the Republic of Tajikistan and the Republic of Uzbekistan to establish a bilateral technical working group, with possible international expert participation acceptable to both parties, to jointly review operational plans for the filling and long-term management of the Rogun Dam reservoir, ensuring minimal adverse downstream impacts and maximizing shared benefits ³⁴;
3. *Requests* the Secretary-General, working through UNRCCA and in collaboration with relevant UN agencies (such as WMO, FAO, UNEP), to strengthen support for

regional capacities in hydrological monitoring, data collection, forecasting, and the establishment of a shared, transparent data platform accessible to all riparian states ⁴¹;

4. *Encourages* Member States, international financial institutions, and the private sector to prioritize and support investments in the rehabilitation and modernization of irrigation infrastructure across Central Asia, particularly in downstream areas, utilizing water-saving technologies to significantly improve water use efficiency ⁵³;
5. *Supports* exploring and developing regional energy markets and cooperation frameworks that facilitate mutually beneficial energy trade, potentially allowing downstream states to provide seasonal energy/financial compensation to upstream states in exchange for optimized water release schedules that meet agricultural needs ³⁴;
6. *Invites* the authorities in Afghanistan to participate in regional dialogues concerning the sustainable management of the Amu Darya River, including transparent information sharing regarding the planning and potential impacts of the Qosh Tepa Canal project ⁴⁰;
7. *Decides* to establish, for an initial period of 24 months, an independent Panel of Experts to monitor the water management situation in the Amu Darya Basin, assess compliance with existing agreements and international norms, and report findings and recommendations to the Security Council every six months;
8. *Strongly condemns* any actions that unilaterally and significantly alter the flow of the Amu Darya River without adequate prior notification, consultation, and impact assessment shared with potentially affected riparian States, considering such actions potentially harmful to regional peace and security;
9. *Further requests* the Secretary-General to integrate climate-related security risk assessments into the regular reporting and analysis provided by UNRCCA, focusing on the impacts of water variability on stability in Central Asia ⁵;
10. *Calls upon* all external States engaged in Central Asia to ensure their diplomatic activities, investments, and development assistance programs support cooperative transboundary water management and regional stability, coordinating efforts where possible to avoid exacerbating resource competition ³⁹;
11. *Reaffirms* that all disputes concerning the Amu Darya Basin must be settled peacefully through negotiation, mediation, or other diplomatic means in accordance with Article 33 of the Charter of the United Nations;
12. *Expresses its readiness* to consider further measures, as necessary, should the situation deteriorate and pose an imminent threat to international peace and security;

13. *Decides* to remain actively seized of the matter.

XI. Conclusion (Revised)

This revised report provides an adapted toolkit for a 3-hour Model UN Security Council simulation on the Amu Darya water conflict, now structured for **28 participants (15 delegates + 13 observers)**. By adding non-delegate roles (Press Corps, NGO Observers, Expert Advisors), the simulation aims to preserve the core Security Council experience for 15 students while offering engaging, alternative learning pathways for the remaining 13.

The updated materials include revised guides for delegates and chairs, modified rules of procedure incorporating observer protocols, new role-specific guidance and assessment rubrics for observers, and adjusted planning checklists and setup tips. While the core content on the Amu Darya conflict remains relevant, successful implementation of this 15+13 model hinges on meticulous planning for observer interaction and highly skilled, proactive chairing to manage the increased complexity within the strict 3-hour timeframe. This approach represents a pragmatic compromise, balancing the desire for broader participation with the need for a focused and manageable simulation exercise.

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